7 URGES all parties concerned to observe both the spirit and intent of these performance standards, to ensure safety is not compromised;
8 INVITES the Assembly to revoke resolutions A.1045(27) and A.1108(29) as of 1 April 2030, and endorse the action taken by the Maritime Safety Committee.
RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025)
PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS

ANNEX

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS

INTRODUCTION

1 Purpose

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ANNEX

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS

INTRODUCTION

1 Purpose

These performance standards provide for requirements for the design, manufacture, construction, rigging, installation of pilot ladder winch reels, operational readiness, onboard inspection and maintenance, familiarization and approval in relation to pilot transfer arrangements required under regulation V/23 of the 1974 SOLAS Convention, adopted by resolution MSC.572(110).

2 Definitions

For the purpose of these performance standards, the following definitions apply:

.1 Pilot transfer arrangements refers to all equipment and arrangements used solely for the embarkation and disembarkation of pilots and other personnel, including pilot ladders, accommodation ladders, embarkation platforms, manropes, pilot ladder winch reels, securing arrangements and other associated equipment.

.2 Point of access means the location at which pilots or other personnel transfer
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associated equipment.

.2 Point of access means the location at which pilots or other personnel transfer between a pilot ladder or accommodation ladder and the deck or side opening of a ship.

.3 Manropes means ropes hung on either side of a pilot ladder for assistance in ascending and descending.

.4 Trapdoor means an aperture with a cover located in a platform allowing the pilot ladder and manropes to pass through without obstruction or distortion and used by pilots or other personnel to transfer between the pilot ladder and the accommodation ladder.

.5 Securing a pilot ladder at intermediate length means securing a pilot ladder at a point other than the thimble ends.

3 General

3.1 Pilot transfer arrangements shall be designed, installed, inspected, maintained and rigged to enable pilots and other personnel to embark and disembark safely in all seagoing conditions of draught and trim.

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rigged to enable pilots and other personnel to embark and disembark safely in all seagoing conditions of draught and trim.

3.2 The height of climb on a pilot ladder shall not be less than 1.5 m and not more than 9 m from the surface of the water to the point of access in all seagoing conditions of draught and trim. Whenever the height of climb on a pilot ladder from the surface of the water to the point of access exceeds 9 m, the ship shall be provided with and rig an accommodation ladder in conjunction with the pilot ladder (i.e. a combination arrangement).

3.3 Where the height of climb is less than 1.5 m from the surface of the water and a pilot ladder is not used as part of a pilot transfer arrangement, this does not exempt any vessel or personnel involved in the transfer from ensuring that the transfer is completed safely, is
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personnel involved in the transfer from ensuring that the transfer is completed safely, is adequately risk assessed and any equipment other than a pilot ladder is used in accordance with these performance standards.

3.4 Pilot transfer arrangements shall be provided to enable pilots and other personnel to embark and disembark safely on either side of the ship. Necessary equipment shall be carried on each side unless the equipment is capable of being transferred for use on either side.

3.5 Pilot ladders and manropes used for the transfer of pilots and other personnel shall

be clearly identified with permanent marking so as to enable identification of each appliance for the purposes of survey, inspection and record-keeping.

3.6 Reference in these performance standards to an accommodation ladder includes a sloping ladder used as part of the pilot transfer arrangements.

3.7 The onboard inspection and rigging of the pilot transfer arrangements and the

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sloping ladder used as part of the pilot transfer arrangements.

3.7 The onboard inspection and rigging of the pilot transfer arrangements and the

embarkation and disembarkation of pilots and other personnel shall be supervised by a designated responsible officer. During the transfer of pilots or other personnel, the responsible officer shall have means of communication with the navigation bridge and shall arrange for the escort of the pilot by a safe route to and from the navigation bridge and other personnel to an appropriate safe location.

PART A DESIGN, MANUFACTURE AND CONSTRUCTION

4 Pilot ladders

4.1 The steps of the pilot ladders shall comply with the following requirements:

.1 if made of hardwood, they shall be made in one piece, free of any knots. Wood shall not be treated or coated with paint, varnish or other coatings;

.2 if made of material other than hardwood, they shall be made from resilient

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.2 if made of material other than hardwood, they shall be made from resilient

plastic or rubber of equivalent strength, stiffness and durability;

.3 they shall have an efficient non-slip surface;

.4 they shall be long enough to accommodate a distance between the inner surface of the side ropes of not less than 400 mm, and shall be not less than 115 mm in width and 25 mm in thickness, excluding any non-slip device or grooving;

.5 they shall be equally spaced not less than 310 mm and not more than 350 mm apart measured from the top of each step or spreader step;

.6 they shall be secured in such a manner that each will remain horizontal; and

.7 the four lowest steps shall be of rubber of sufficient strength and stiffness or other equivalent material.

4.2 Pilot ladders with more than five steps shall have spreader steps complying with paragraph 4.1 and each spreader step shall be not less than 1.8 m in length. The lowest

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paragraph 4.1 and each spreader step shall be not less than 1.8 m in length. The lowest

spreader step shall be the fifth step from the bottom of the ladder and additional spreader steps shall be provided at such intervals as will prevent the pilot ladder from twisting, conforming to standards acceptable to the Organization.

4.3 Permanent measuring marking shall be provided at a regular interval of every three steps, approximately every 1 m, throughout the length of the pilot ladder consistent with ladder design, use and maintenance in order to facilitate the rigging of the ladder to the required height.
4.4 Pilot ladders shall be permanently marked by the manufacturer with at least the following information on the underside of the uppermost step and the lowermost spreader step:
.1 the name of the manufacturer;

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following information on the underside of the uppermost step and the lowermost spreader step:
.1 the name of the manufacturer;
.2 an equipment serial number or other means of unique identification which the manufacturer shall be able to validate;
.3 date of manufacture; and
.4 name and details of the approving authority.
4.5 Pilot ladders shall be of a single length capable of reaching the surface of the water from the point of access or, where a combination arrangement is used, from the platform of the combination arrangement, in all seagoing conditions of draught and trim a nd the specific condition of an adverse list of 15° in the lightest seagoing condition.
4.6 The side ropes on each side of the pilot ladder shall consist of a double length of uncovered rope not less than 20 mm and not more than 22 mm in diameter. The double length shall be made from a continuous length of rope with no joints having a breaking strength of at
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shall be made from a continuous length of rope with no joints having a breaking strength of at least 24 kN. The midpoint of the double length shall be located on a thimble. The ends of each of the side ropes shall be properly finished.2F
4.7 Each of the side rope s shall be mildew -resistant manila rope 3For other material of equivalent strength, durability, elongation characteristics and grip which has been protected against actinic degradation.
4.8 Each of the side ropes shall be secured together both above and below each step with an arrangement properly designed for this purpose. Where a seizing method4Fwith step fixtures, such as chocks or wedges, is used, it shall hold each step horizontal in all planes at all times. Where a mechanical clamping device is used to secure each of the side ropes together, it shall grip each of the side ropes in the pair independently and with the same grip force. Any surface
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